

7 Bars, tabs and navigation

7.1 More stuff in 480x320

We have already considered two ways of creating multi-view application and switching between them via either segmented control or Round Rect button View based switch. The problem of limited visual space is encountered so often that the iPhone SDK provides a more polished way of dealing with them. They are referred to as “Tab-bar” Application.

If you have wondered how to create the iPod-style navigation based application, we shall also attempt to answer that question now. An example of this style of application is the settings application in your iPhone or iPod. Here you are displayed with a list of items and you can select one to be displayed with another sub list. We will discuss creation of both kind of application which will complete your arsenal of designing a GUI meeting the most encountered problems. Let us start with Tab-Bar applications.

7.2 Tab bar applications

Without wasting further time on textual theory, stretch out your fingers and launch XCode, but this time choose Tab-Bar Applications. Let us call it “tba” for Tab Bar Application. We will begin with analysing and understanding what is provided to us by default in the template and then later move on to adding new tabs.

If you notice in your “groups and files” pane, this time for *.xib files there are two files,



A two tab UI displayed in the simulator. Dots reflect multi-touch